



WE THE PEOPLE

Reunite the Country
Transform the System



Britain in 2026 feels like
she's in a tough place.

We The People is a vision of how
we can change our fortunes
and our future together.

The task is enormous.

But this could be the first step...

1. The Idea

We all know things are going wrong. We all feel it.

Everyone has their own list: cost of living, inequality, immigration, child poverty, global conflict - or maybe it's the potholes.

As a result, many feel powerless, angry, afraid or disillusioned.

So where can we
find hope?



System Failure

The people supposedly in charge - our politicians - seem to be struggling too. So we don't know where to turn.

Some keep faith with traditional parties. Others turn to populist outsiders. Many don't bother to vote at all.

Who can blame them? Whoever we vote for, everything keeps getting worse.

No wonder trust in politicians is the lowest it's ever been.

Yet there is another way. A possibility we have overlooked...





**We the People can
do it ourselves**

Just think of the collective energy, wisdom and creativity among all 70 million of us.

Imagine what could happen if we brought that collective genius to bear. We might discover that our challenges are not as insurmountable as they seem.

Our current system is an obvious obstacle to realising that potential.

But there is another, equally significant: how divided we are.

Healing Divisions

Stoked by divisive media, economic pressure and social alienation, our society feels more polarised than ever*.

Politicians increasingly pitch to those extremes. The centre cannot hold.

But **We The People** still believe in democracy.

That we can find a way to talk, compromise and forge a shared vision for our future, no matter how difficult that might seem right now.

Thankfully a powerful democratic mechanism exists to do just that.

*<https://www.ipsos.com/en-uk/uks-sense-division-reaches-new-high-culture-war-tensions-grow-study-finds>

It's called a Citizens' Assembly

In simple terms it applies the principles of jury service to politics.

A group of 100 or so ordinary people are selected at random to reflect the population as a whole by factors like class, age, gender, race etc.

They are given a difficult societal problem to face. They listen to experts & witnesses from all sides of the debate, and then talk among themselves to forge policy approaches that everyone can accept.



Why it works

Normal people are at the heart of the process so the public feel better represented than by an ego-driven political class.

Free from the pressures to win votes or funding, an assembly's decisions have greater legitimacy too.

Most importantly, impartial facilitation allows every perspective to be heard. That creates room for understanding, respect - even empathy.

We start to believe in "us" again.



So we go
from this....





To this

And in that way start to change the world.



It is already happening

Across the world, assemblies are already at work, helping to resolve previously intractable political problems.

In Ireland, one led to the legalisation of abortion. In France to an agreement on assisted dying.

We've even had one in the UK on climate change that led to rare agreement between right and left.

This democratic mechanism has deep historical roots - and now offers hope for a peaceful, united path through this hour of crisis.

This is how we can turn things around.

2: In Practice

The First Step

Britain has no shortage of problems.
But we believe our work must start with the issue
that most urgently threatens its collective life.



Immigration

On nothing else do our divisions run as deep, our emotions as violent, or do the force of our disagreements so threaten our sense of shared values.





So we will hold
A National Citizens' Assembly

To ask
**How might we approach immigration
as a country?**

Council of the People



“Citizens’ Assembly” sounds a bit like jargon. So we’ll call this a “Council of the People.” And that’s exactly what it will be: a gathering of our people where all are welcome and where every perspective is heard.

These could include positive stories of the beauty of British culture or contributions made by refugees. Or they could be negative stories of racist attacks or violence perpetrated by immigrants.

Wherever you sit on the spectrum, you are going to hear stories you don’t agree with. And that will be hard.

But this is the heart of the process, the leap we’re asking everyone to make: if you want your story and your perspective to be honoured then you must honour others when it’s their turn.



Truth & Reconciliation

We intend the Council to embody a spirit of truth and reconciliation, similar to the Commissions that have taken place around the world from Canada to South Africa.

A place where all sides can speak without fear of judgment. Where ghosts from the past can be faced. Where we can express anger, grief, even shed tears.

An opportunity for the communities of this island to share their stories at last, in search of a more united, hopeful future.

A Moment of National Cultural Impact

In that way, the Council of the People aims to have a broad positive effect on our society as a whole.

To that end, we will aim to engage as many people as possible by making the Council exciting, emotional - even entertaining.

We will involve high profile cultural figures from across the arts, music, film & TV both to drive public awareness and of course share their perspectives too.



The Event

The Council will be a singular event over a focused period of time, from ten days to two weeks.

In this way, we hope to build an unfolding narrative whose twists and turns will engage the public and fuel compelling tension over the outcome.

During that time, the site will be accessible with music, food, exhibitions and relevant events to draw audiences to attend in person.



With The People

The background image is a photograph of a person pushing a stroller at night. The person and the stroller are in silhouette, moving from left to right. They are positioned in front of a textured wall that is illuminated with a warm, orange light, likely from a street lamp. To the left of the person is a doorway, and to the right is a window with multiple panes. The overall mood is quiet and contemplative.

We will also create a broad media ecosystem for people to engage whoever and wherever they are in the country.

- Social as well as legacy media to reach every generation
- Newsworthy viral events
- Live streams of Council sessions
- Daily highlight shows on a range of platforms
- An app where users can follow proceedings, post comments and interact through polls on policy ideas
- A documentary to tell the Council's story
- A portal for people to submit their own stories building an archive of our national memory on immigration

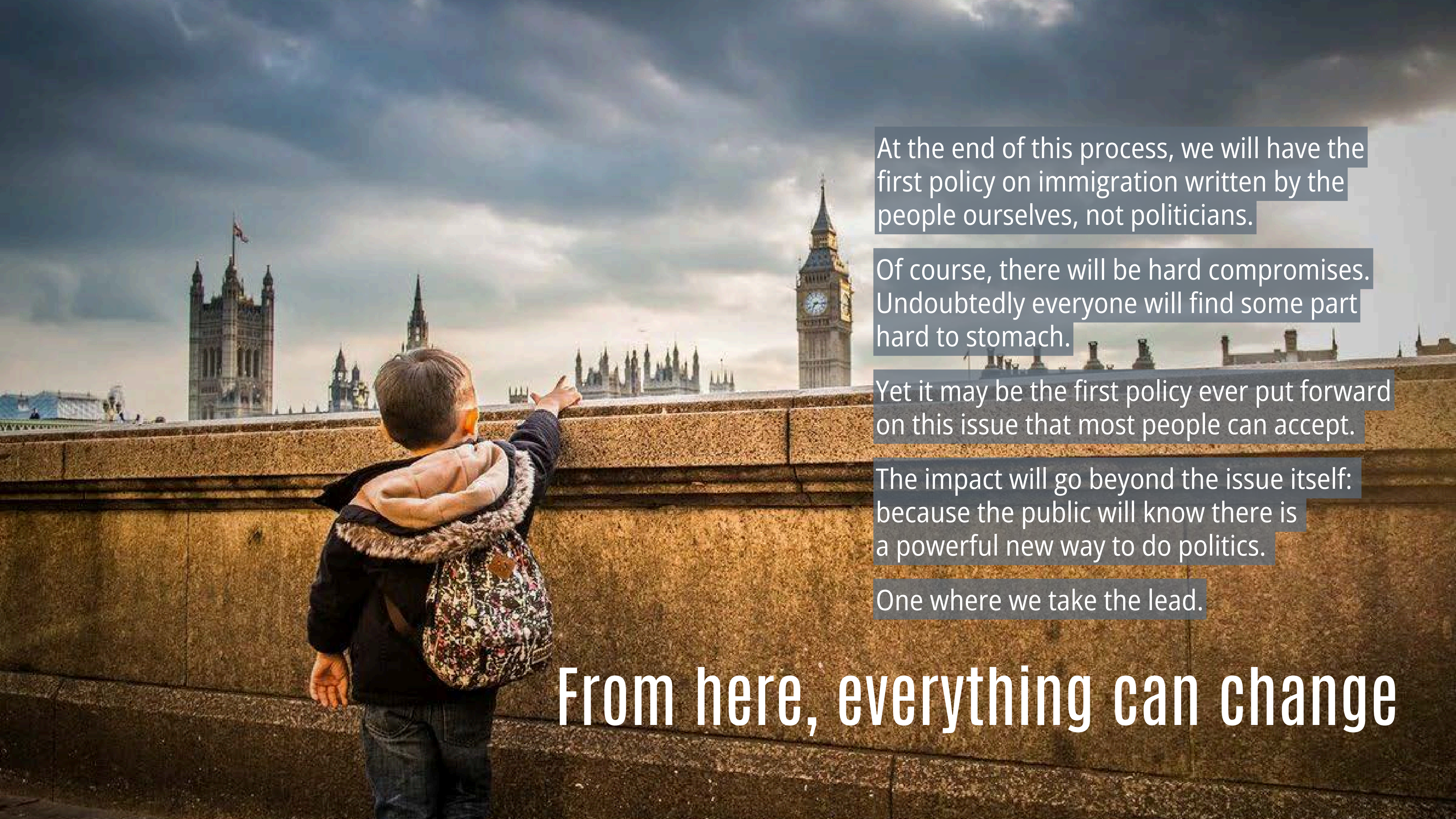
The goal: to make people feel part of our democracy again, where their contributions are valued and counted, rather than ignored.



We The People of... Orkney Dover Brixton Rochdale Cardiff Hastings & more

We will also encourage and support simultaneous wildcat grassroots Councils on immigration, almost like street parties during the Jubilee.

The dream: to inspire a wave of peace, truth and reconciliation efforts in communities across the country.



At the end of this process, we will have the first policy on immigration written by the people ourselves, not politicians.

Of course, there will be hard compromises. Undoubtedly everyone will find some part hard to stomach.

Yet it may be the first policy ever put forward on this issue that most people can accept.

The impact will go beyond the issue itself: because the public will know there is a powerful new way to do politics.

One where we take the lead.

From here, everything can change



The Next Steps

You may ask, what's to stop the politicians ignoring us as always?

Our strategy will be to build *We The People* into a movement– perhaps even a new political party – to compel the system to listen to us.

Immigration is only the start.

We will go on to hold Councils of the People on other issues tearing us apart, from cost of living to taxation to the regulation of AI.

With each step, we build a vision for our future written by us – a People's Manifesto – while growing a Movement fighting for us all.

WE THE PEOPLE

BE PART OF HOPE

Read our full strategy and sign up at:
www.wethepeoplegather.com

